🗺️ Building Pose Maps and Road Network Annotation

1. Course Content

Before road network planning and navigation, robots need two foundational components:

1. **High-precision spatial map and pose graph**: Use LiDAR and Cartographer SLAM to scan the environment, generating a 2D grid map (`map.yaml` / `map.pgm`) and a pose graph (`map.pbstream`) for fast relocalization;
2. **Topological road network description file (`map.geojson`)**: On the completed map, use the visualization tool `Route Tool` to mark road points (Node) and connected road segments (Edge), set one-way or two-way traffic rules, and save.

> **Note**
>
> - Before annotating the road network `.geojson` file, you must have at least one environment grid map.
> - Saving the Cartographer pose map (`.pbstream`) enables fast and precise global relocalization during subsequent navigation, completely avoiding cumulative drift from wheel slip.
> - This tutorial uses the standard working path (user path `~/map`) as the main demonstration, while being compatible with various industrial PC platforms.

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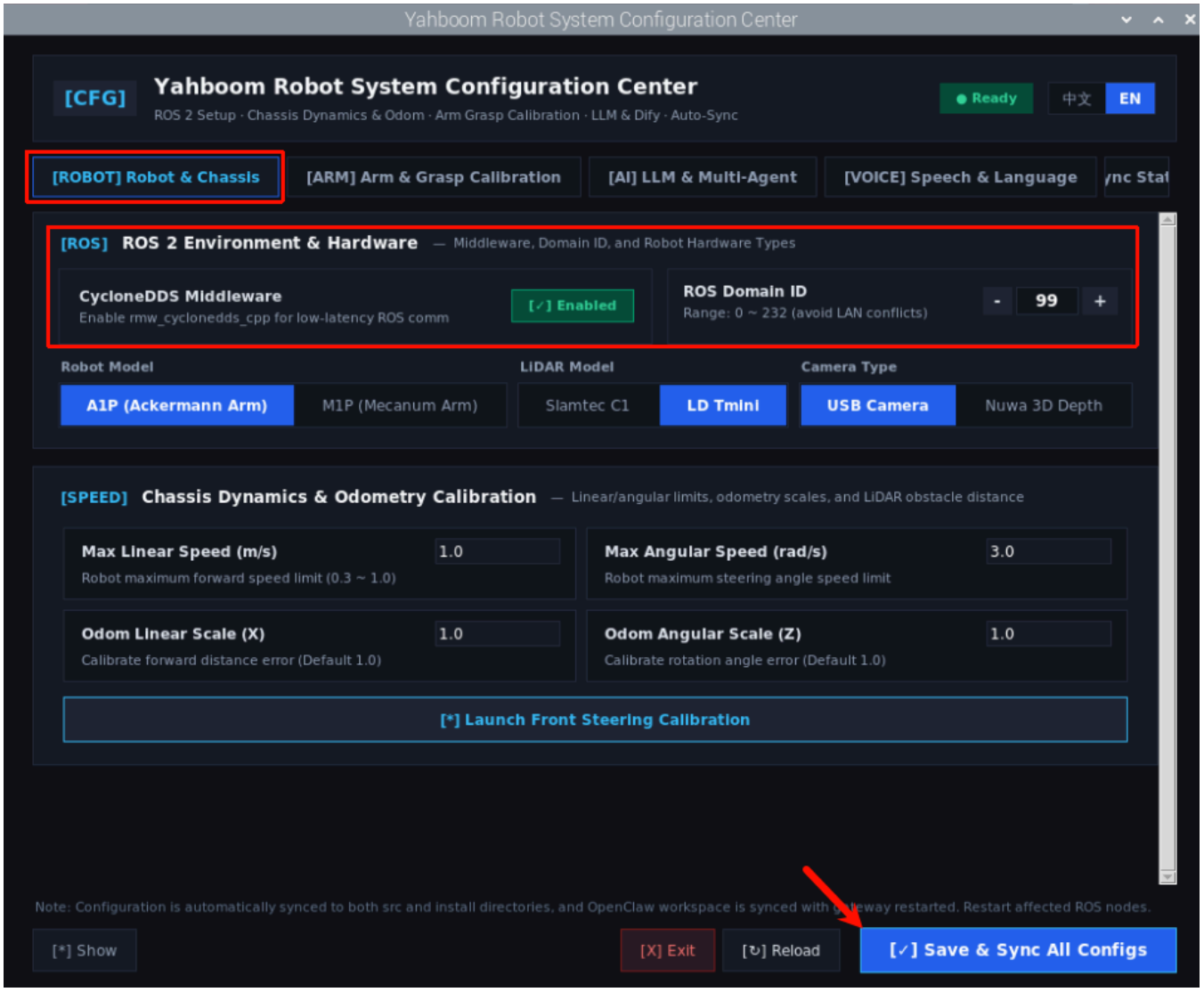
2. Phase 1: Building Grid Map and Pose Map

2.1 Check ROS 2 Environment Configuration on Master and Slave Machines

Click the app on the desktop to configure robot parameters



Mainly configure two parts: ROS 2 communication middleware and Domain ID. Other configurations will be set up when needed later.



Click Save and Sync Configuration. Exit after configuration is complete.

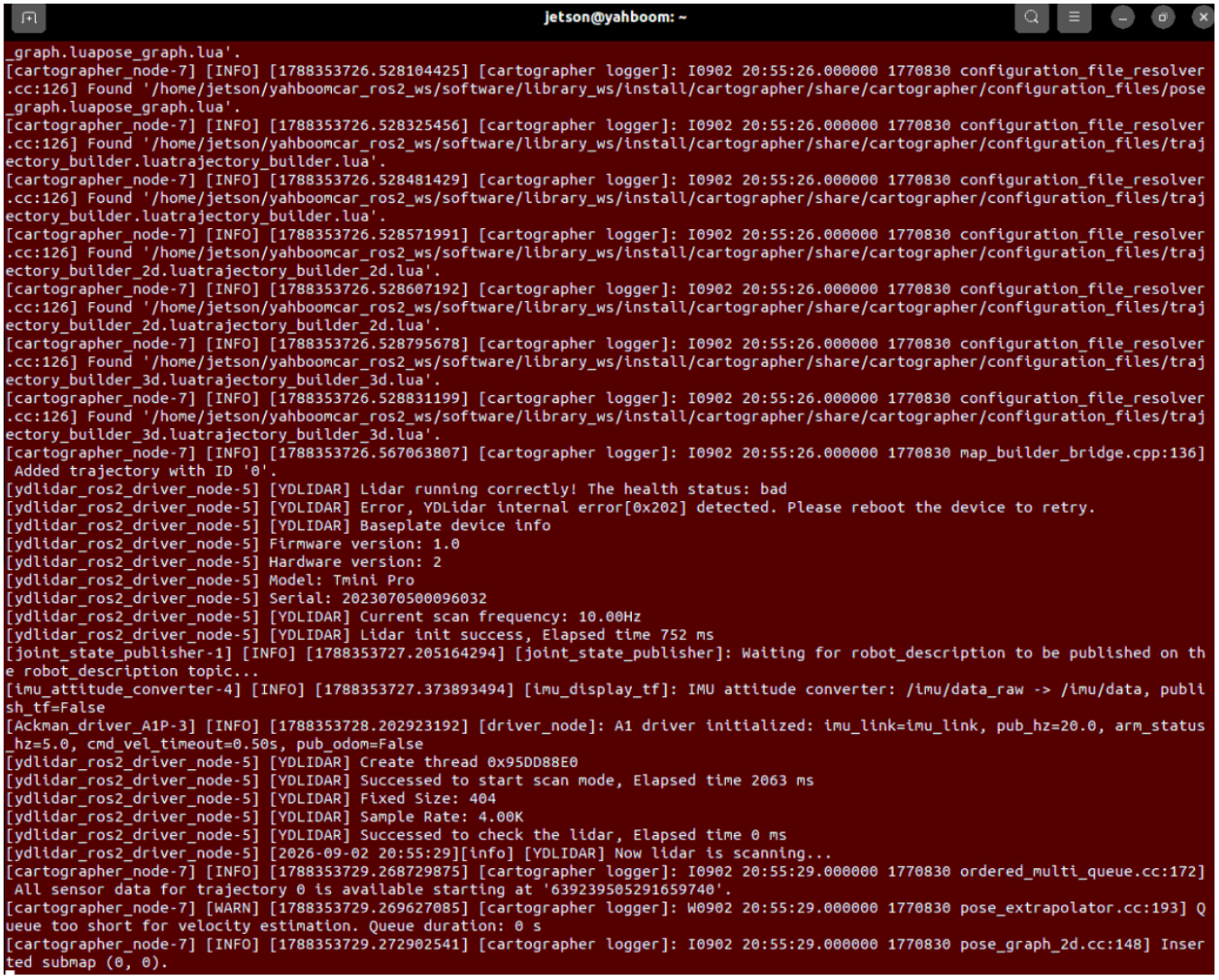
> **Tip**
>
> Before mapping, you can place some cardboard boxes or wooden blocks outside the road boundaries on the map as contour reference objects. This helps the robot's LiDAR have sufficient geometric features for matching during mapping and navigation.

2.2 Start Cartographer Mapping

This phase requires opening 3 terminals for collaborative mapping:

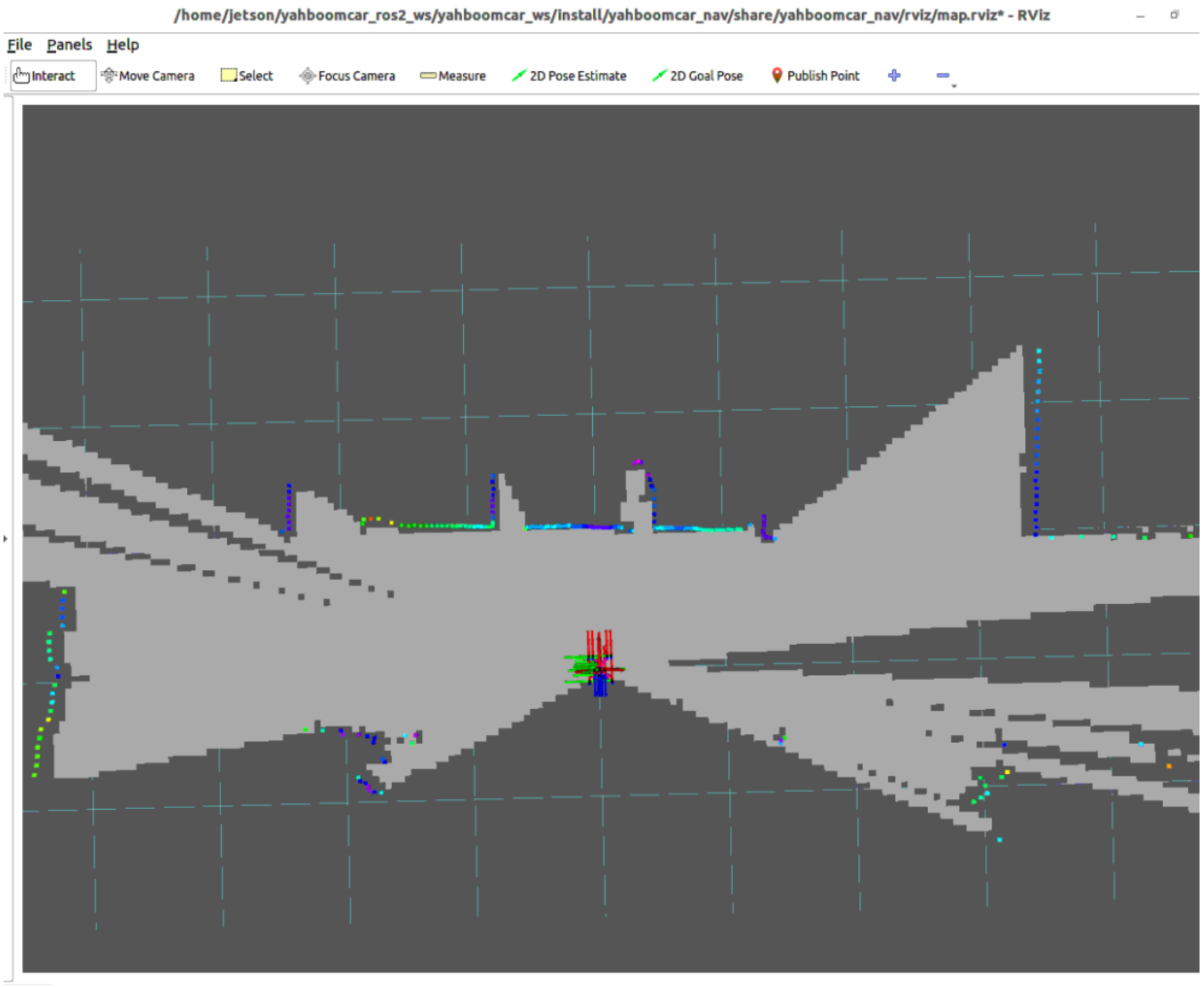
Terminal 1: Start Robot Chassis and Cartographer Mapping Node (Robot Side)

```
ros2 launch yahboomcar_nav map_cartographer_launch.py
```



Terminal 2: Start RViz Mapping Visualization (RDK motherboard and Raspberry Pi motherboard recommend using the virtual machine side)

```
ros2 launch yahboomcar_nav display_map_launch.py
```



Terminal 3: Start Keyboard Control Node

```
ros2 run yahboomcar_ctrl yahboom_keyboard
```

2.3 Save Grid Map and Pose Map

After mapping is complete, execute the save commands in sequence in the terminal:

1. Save 2D Grid Map (`map.yaml` + `map.pgm`)

```
# Save map to ~/map
ros2 launch yahboomcar_nav save_map_launch.py map_save_dir:=/home/jetson/map map_name:=map
```

When the terminal prints `Map saved successfully`, the 2D map has been saved successfully:

```
jetson@yahboom:~/yahboomcar_ros2_ws/dofbot_pro_ws$ ros2 launch yahboomcar_nav save_map_launch.py map_save_dir:=/home/jetson/map map_nam
=map
[INFO] [launch]: All log files can be found below /home/jetson/.ros/log/2026-09-02-21-00-06-127410-yahboom-1782648
[INFO] [launch]: Default logging verbosity is set to INFO
[INFO] [map_saver_cli-1]: process started with pid [1782694]
[map_saver_cli-1] [INFO] [1788354006.421090359] [map_saver]:
[map_saver_cli-1]       map_saver lifecycle node launched.
[map_saver_cli-1]       Waiting on external lifecycle transitions to activate
[map_saver_cli-1]       See https://design.ros2.org/articles/node_lifecycle.html for more information.
[map_saver_cli-1] [INFO] [1788354006.421331998] [map_saver]: Creating
[map_saver_cli-1] [INFO] [1788354006.421473986] [map_saver]: Configuring
[map_saver_cli-1] [INFO] [1788354006.425505113] [map_saver]: Saving map from 'map' topic to '/home/jetson/map/map' file
[map_saver_cli-1] [WARN] [1788354006.508404952] [map_io]: Image format unspecified. Setting it to: pgm
[map_saver_cli-1] [INFO] [1788354006.508558909] [map_io]: Received a 405 X 518 map @ 0.05 m/pix
[map_saver_cli-1] [INFO] [1788354006.682667696] [map_io]: Writing map occupancy data to /home/jetson/map/map.pgm
[map_saver_cli-1] [INFO] [1788354006.688636447] [map_io]: Writing map metadata to /home/jetson/map/map.yaml
[map_saver_cli-1] [INFO] [1788354006.688884294] [map_io]: Map saved
[map_saver_cli-1] [INFO] [1788354006.688905543] [map_saver]: Map saved successfully
[map_saver_cli-1] [INFO] [1788354006.692686486] [map_saver]: Destroying
[INFO] [map_saver_cli-1]: process has finished cleanly [pid 1782694]
jetson@yahboom:~/yahboomcar_ros2_ws/dofbot_pro_ws$
```

2. Save Cartographer Pose Map (`map.pbstream`)

Through ROS 2 service call, write the current trajectory map and submap constraints to the `.pbstream` file:

```
# RDK X5 system (sunrise user)
ros2 service call /write_state cartographer_ros_msgs/srv/WriteState "{filename:
'/home/sunrise/map/map.pbstream'}"

# If master machine is jetson user
ros2 service call /write_state cartographer_ros_msgs/srv/WriteState "{filename:
'/home/jetson/map/map.pbstream'}"

# pi5 user
ros2 service call /write_state cartographer_ros_msgs/srv/WriteState "{filename:
'/root/map/map.pbstream'}"
```

```
jetson@yahboom:~/yahboomcar_ros2_ws/dofbot_pro_ws$ ros2 service call /write_state cartographer_ros_msgs/srv/WriteState "{filename: '/home
/jetson/map/map.pbstream'}"
requester: making request: cartographer_ros_msgs.srv.WriteState_Request(filename='/home/jetson/map/map.pbstream', include_unfinished_subm
aps=False)

response:
cartographer_ros_msgs.srv.WriteState_Response(status=cartographer_ros_msgs.msg.StatusResponse(code=0, message="State written to '/home/je
tson/map/map.pbstream'."))

jetson@yahboom:~/yahboomcar_ros2_ws/dofbot_pro_ws$
```

Map files are saved in `~/map` or the specified directory by default, containing three core assets: `map.yaml`, `map.pgm`, and `map.pbstream`:

```
jetson@yahboom:~/map$ ll
total 2780
drwxrwxr-x  3 jetson jetson    4096 Mar 21 17:54 ./
drwxr-xr-x 51 jetson jetson    4096 Sep  2 20:33 ../
drwxrwxr-x  2 jetson jetson    4096 Jan 26  2026 data/
-rw-r--r--  1 root   root      4579 Mar 21 17:53 map.geojson
-rw-rw-r--  1 jetson jetson 2607313 Sep  2 21:00 map.pbstream
-rw-rw-r--  1 jetson jetson  209805 Sep  2 21:00 map.pgm
-rw-rw-r--  1 jetson jetson     122 Sep  2 21:00 map.yaml
jetson@yahboom:~/map$
```

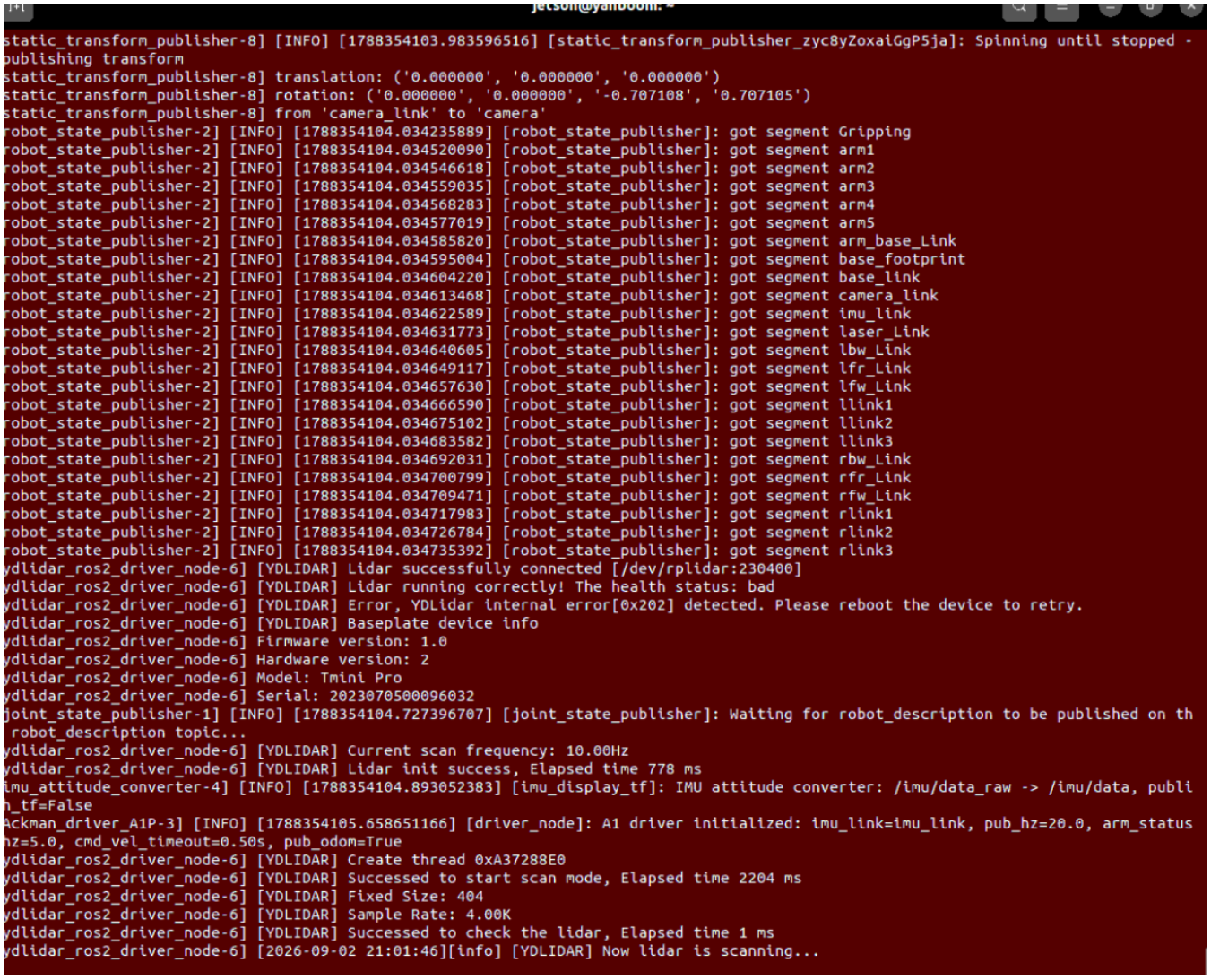
3. Phase 2: Road Network Annotation (Route Annotation)

3.1 Start Global Localization and Annotation Tools

When annotating the road network, the system needs to know the robot's precise coordinates in the global map in real time. Therefore, first start the chassis driver and navigation localization node.

Terminal 1: Start Robot Chassis and LiDAR Driver (Robot Side)

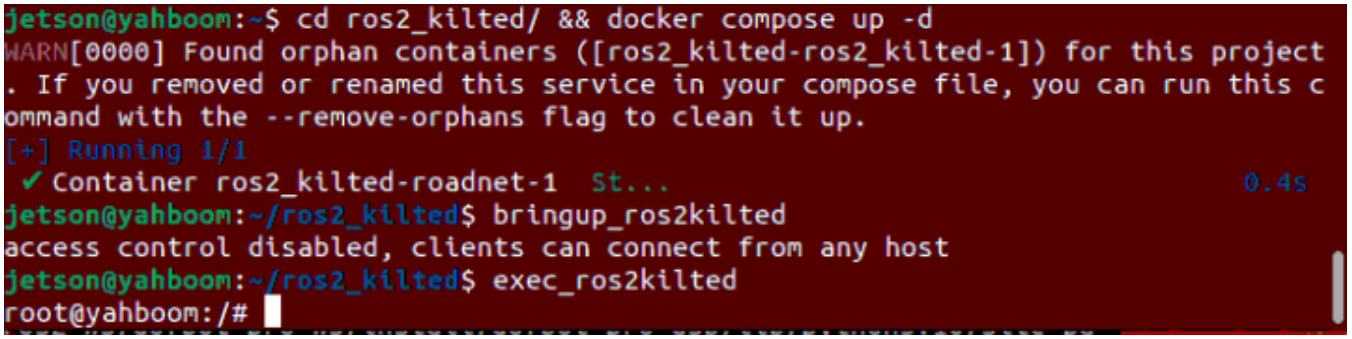
```
ros2 launch yahboomcar_nav laser_bringup_launch.py
```



Terminal 2: Start Docker Container Environment

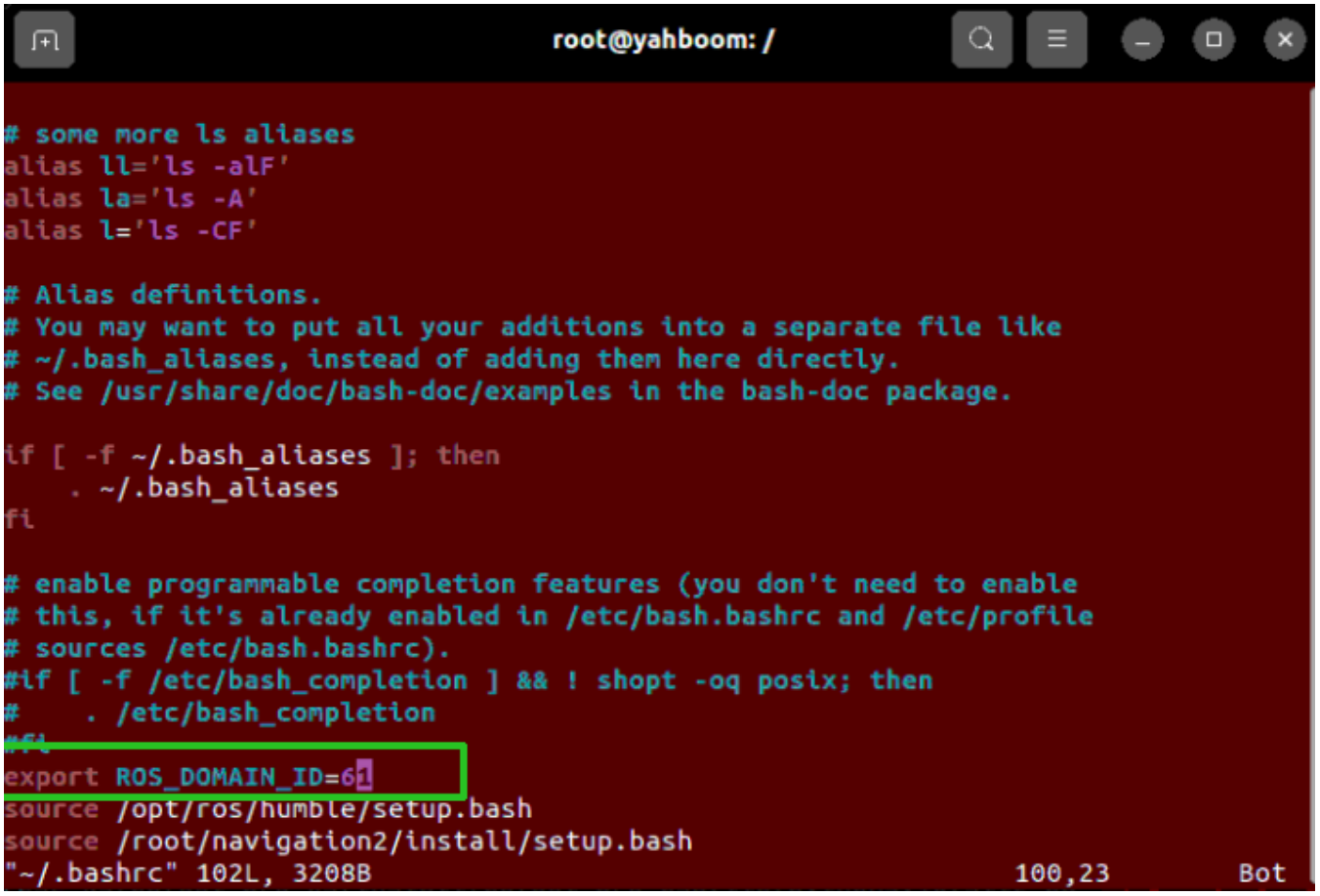
If using the `ros2_kilted` container environment:

```
# Quick start command
bringup_ros2kilted
# Enter container terminal
exec_ros2kilted
```



Enter in the terminal to ensure the container and host machine `ROS_DOMAIN_ID` are consistent:

```
vi ~/.bashrc
```

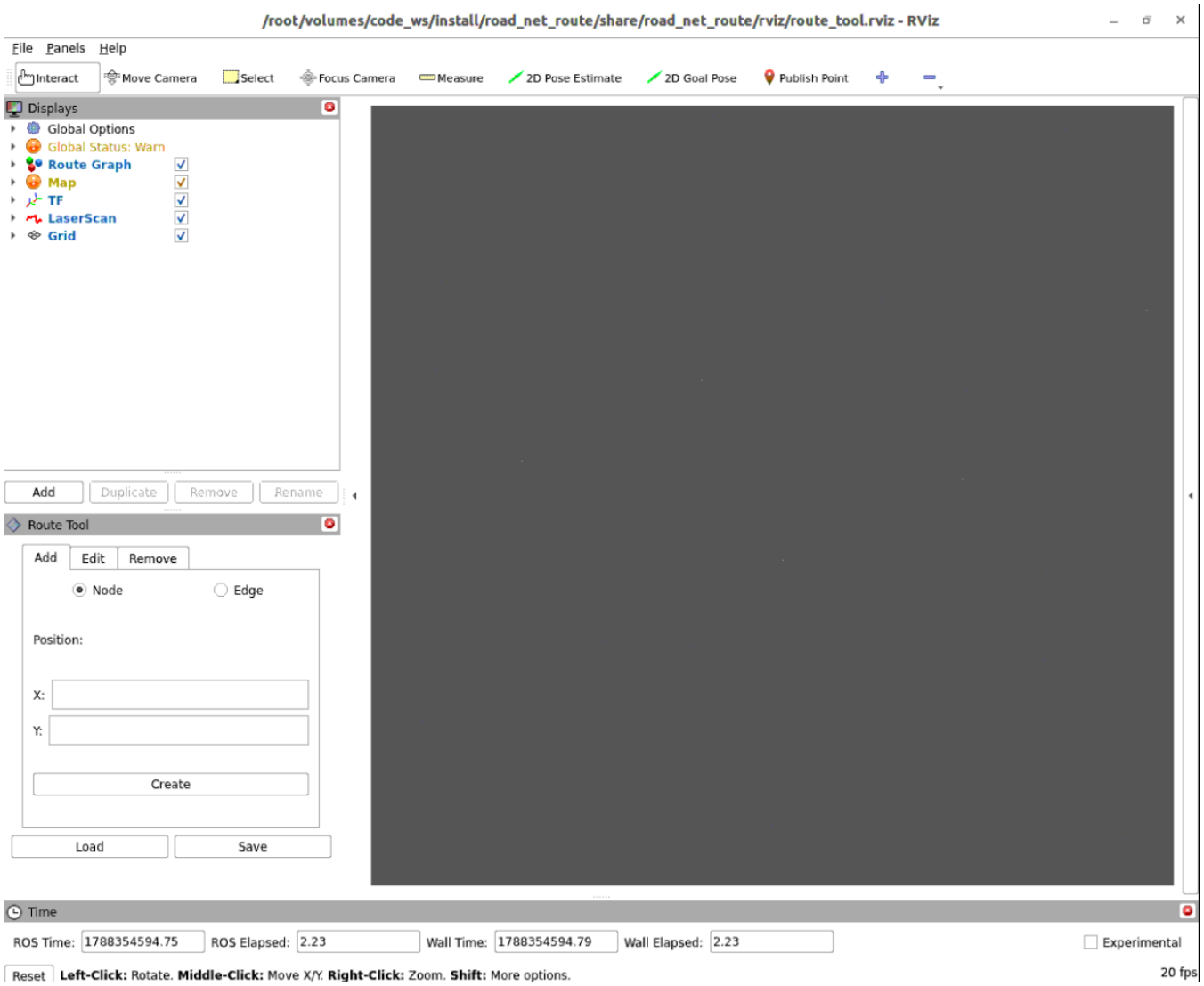


Terminal 3: Start Road Network Annotation RViz Tool Panel (Road Network Side)

Run the annotation interface on the motherboard/virtual machine or inside the container: **(RDK and Raspberry Pi motherboards need to start RViz with integrated tools on the virtual machine)**

```
# Start annotation tool standalone panel
ros2 launch road_net_route route_tool.launch.py
```

This demonstrates the Orin motherboard.

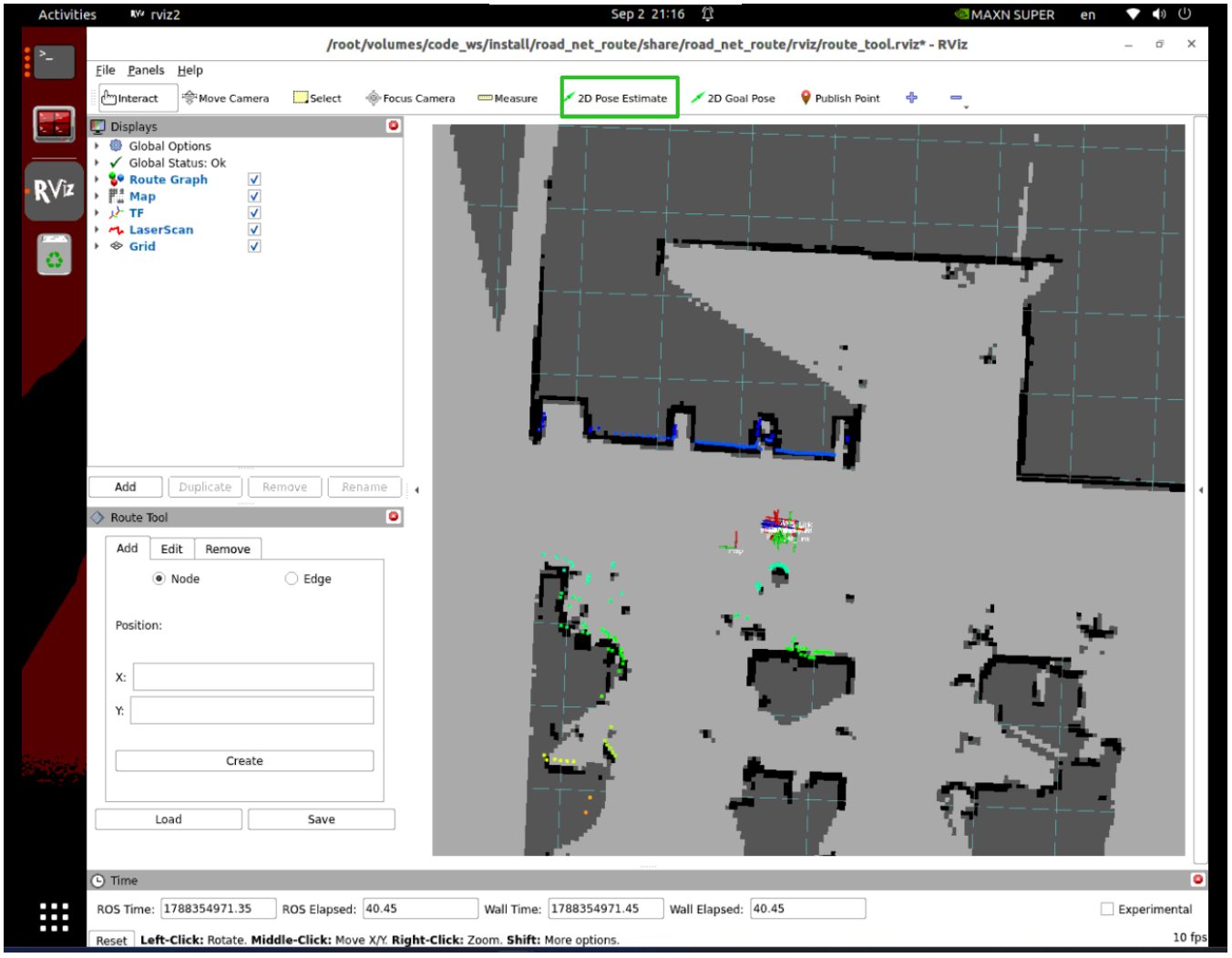


Terminal 4: Start Navigation Base to Load Map (Robot Side)

```
# RDK X5 system
ros2 launch yahboomcar_nav navigation_teb_launch.py map:=/home/sunrise/map/map.yaml

# Or Jetson master machine
ros2 launch yahboomcar_nav navigation_teb_launch.py map:=/home/jetson/map/map.yaml
```

In RViz, use the **2D Pose Estimate** button in the toolbar to give the robot an initial pose on the map, so that the LiDAR scan contour precisely aligns with the black and white obstacle edges on the map:



3.2 Interactively Add Road Points (Nodes)

1. Click the `Publish Point` tool in the RViz top toolbar;
2. Move the mouse to the robot's current center position (or the center of the passage you want to set as a station on the map), and left-click the mouse;
3. The `Route Tool` panel in the lower left will automatically read and fill in the X/Y coordinates of that point. Click `Create` to create the road point:



4. Use keyboard control to move the robot to the next location that needs a road point marker, and repeat clicking `Publish Point` -> `Create`:

```
ros2 run yahboomcar_ctrl yahboom_keyboard
```

```
jetson@yahboom:~/map$ ros2 run yahboomcar_ctrl yahboom_keyboard

q/z : increase/decrease max speeds by 10%
w/x : increase/decrease only linear speed by 10%
e/c : increase/decrease only angular speed by 10%
t/T : x and y speed switch
s/S : stop keyboard control
space key, k : force stop

Arm Control (publish to 'arm_joint'):
1 - 6 : Select Joint 1~6
a / d : Increase (+) / Decrease (-) selected joint angle (step: 5 deg)
+ / - : Increase (+) / Decrease (-) selected joint angle (step: 5 deg)
0     : Reset all joints to initial pose

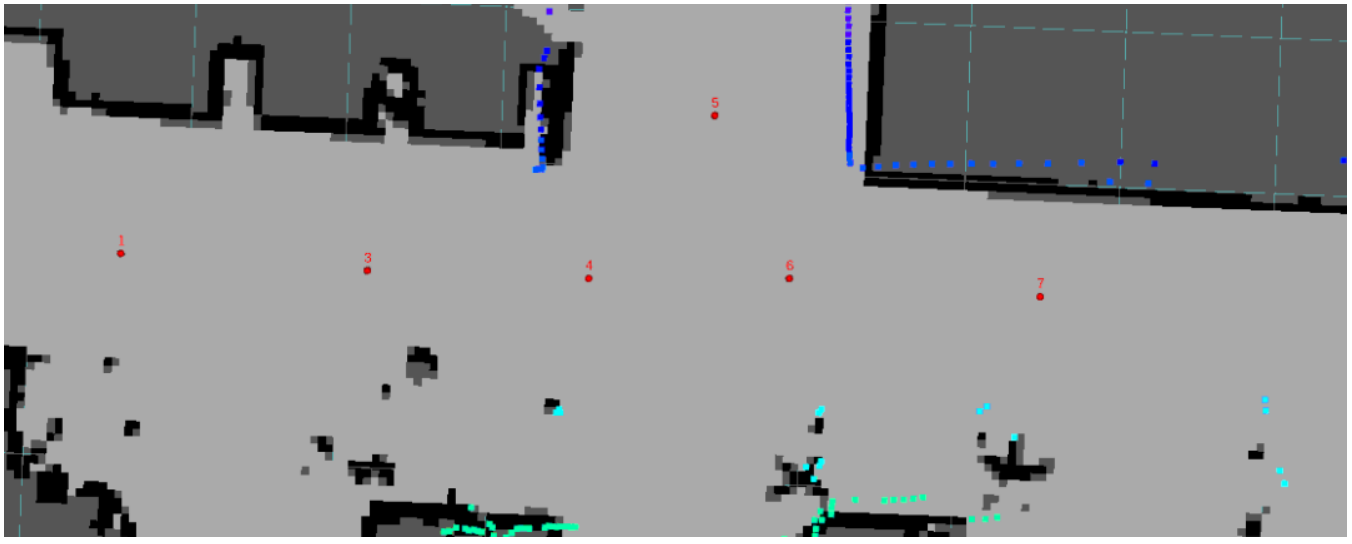
Angle Limits:
Joint 1~4 : 0° ~ 180°
Joint 5   : 0° ~ 270°
Joint 6   : 0° ~ 180°

anything else : stop smoothly
CTRL-C to quit

currently:      speed 0.2       turn 1.0
Current Joint Selection: Joint 1 (90°)
```

> ⚠ **Warning**
>
> If the LiDAR contour becomes slightly misaligned with the map due to wheel slip during point annotation, you can manually use 2D Pose Estimate in RViz. After the localization converges and matches, continue annotating the next road point.

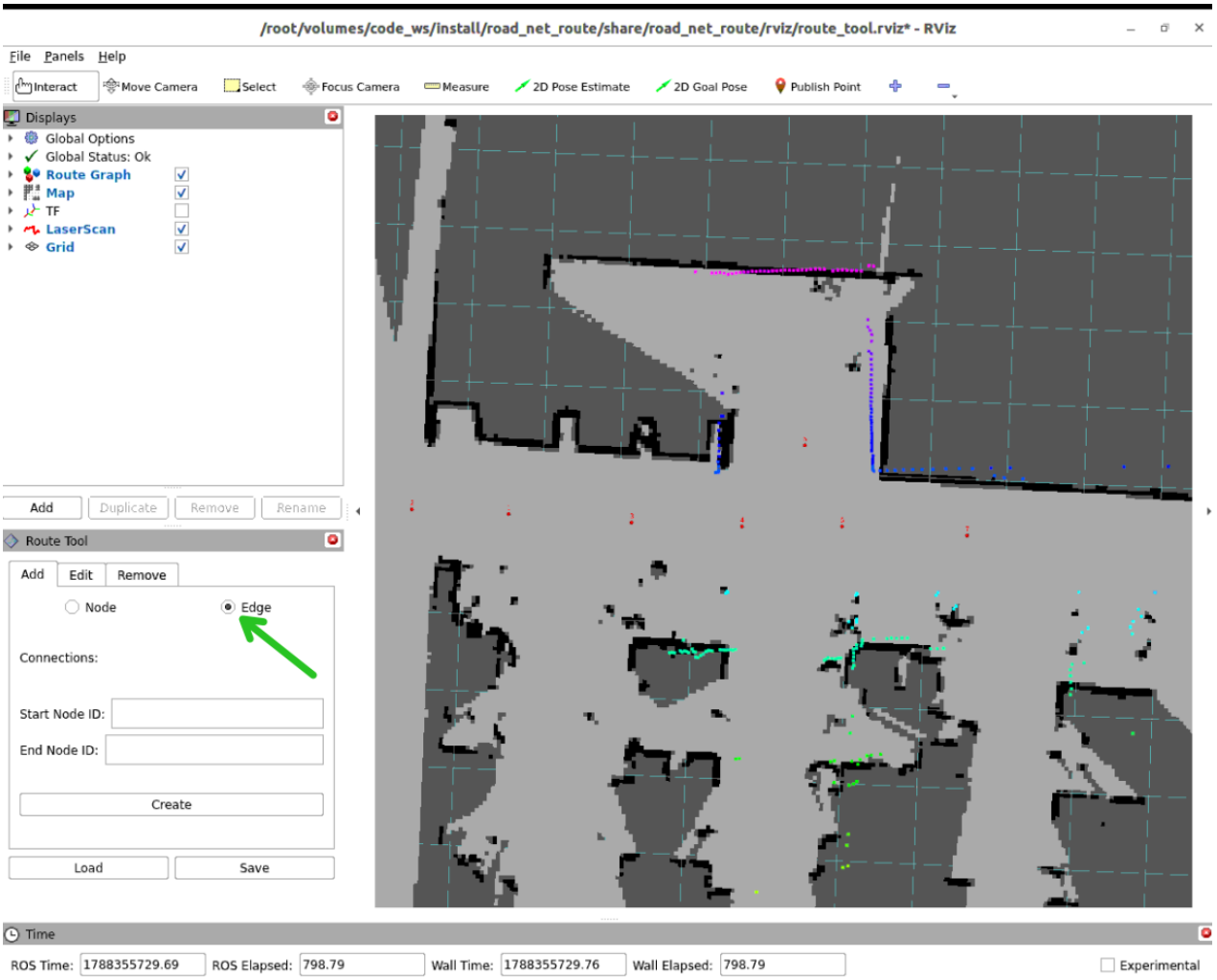
5. Annotate all target key stations in sequence (such as road points 0, 1, 2, ...):



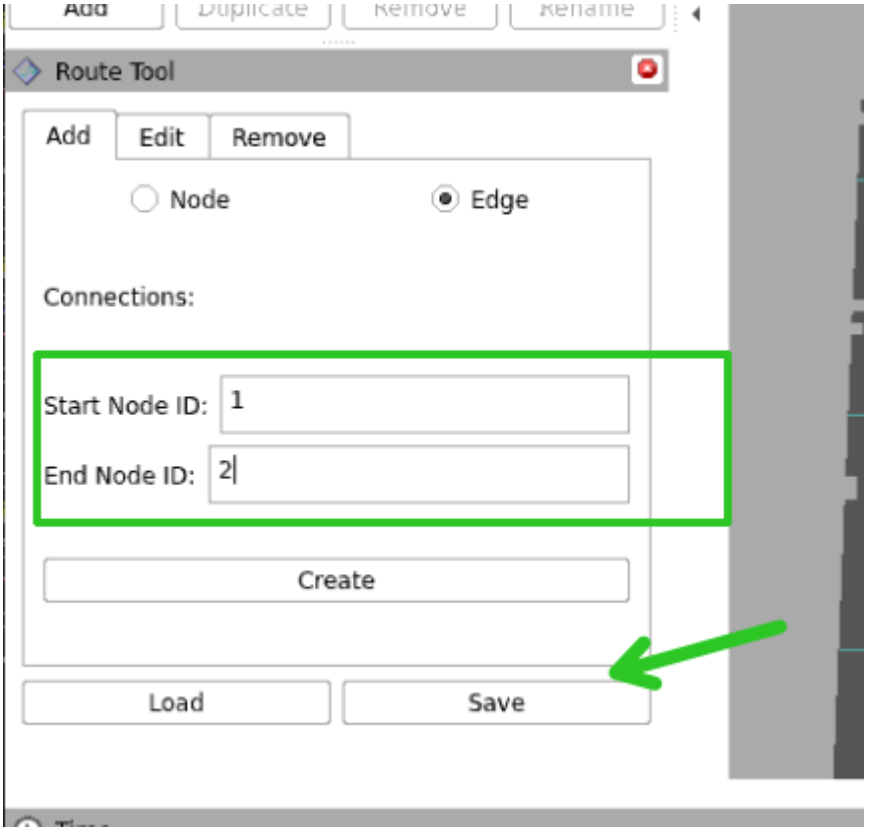
3.3 Interactively Add Directed Edges (Edges)

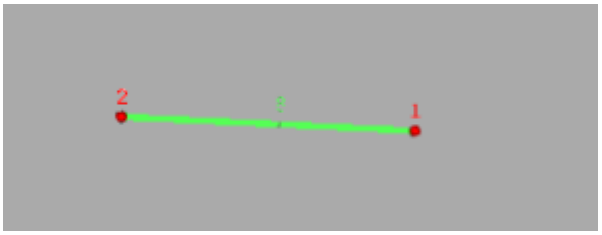
The road network is a typical **directed topological graph** structure. Only when "edges" are connected between points can the robot travel between them.

1. Switch to the `Edge` page at the top of the `Route Tool` tab;



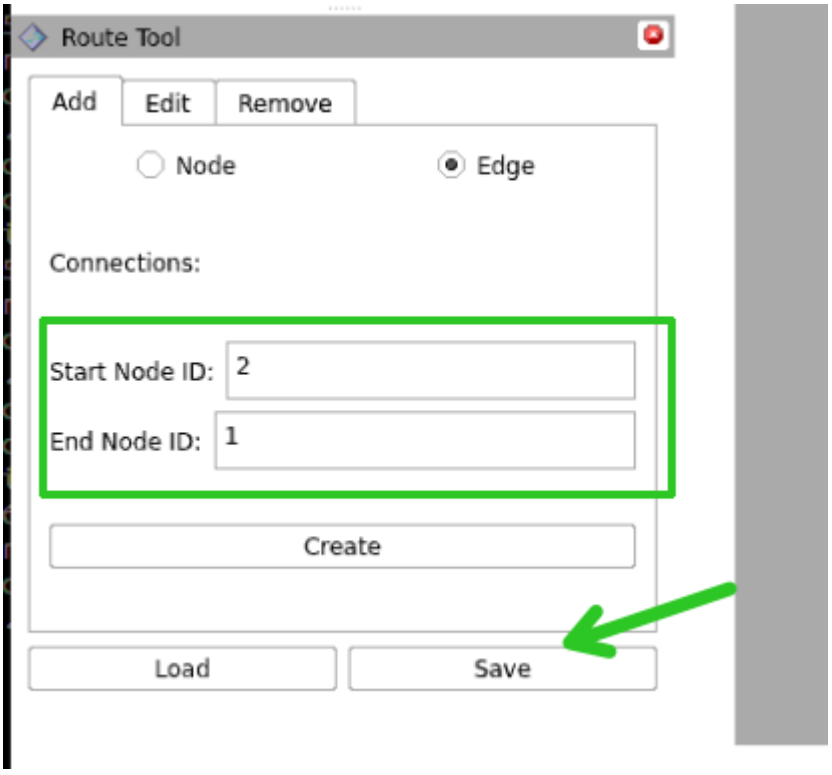
2. Enter the starting point number in `Start Node ID` (such as 1), enter the ending point number in `End Node ID` (such as 2), and click `Create`:

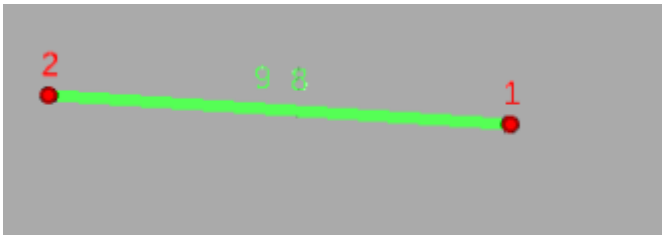




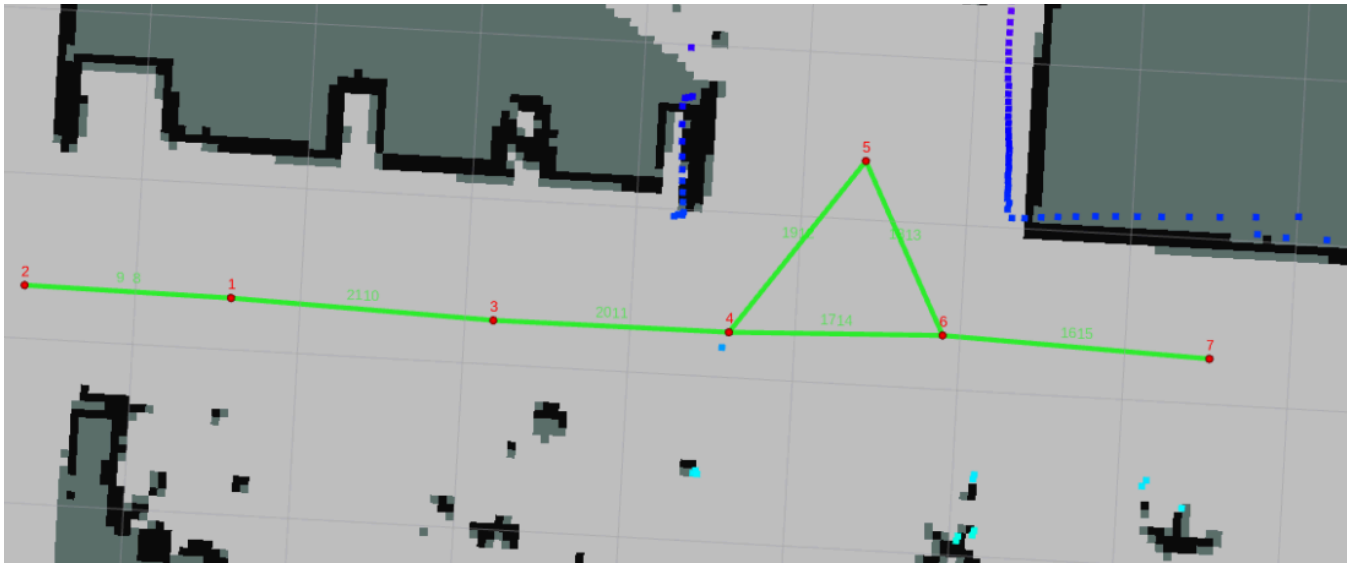
> **Important**
>
> **Special Note: Edges have directionality!**
> Creating 1 -> 2 means this is a **one-way street** (only allowed to travel from 1 to 2, reverse driving prohibited). If this road allows two-way traffic, you must create another 2 -> 1 edge!

3. Create reverse edges for two-way traffic lanes:



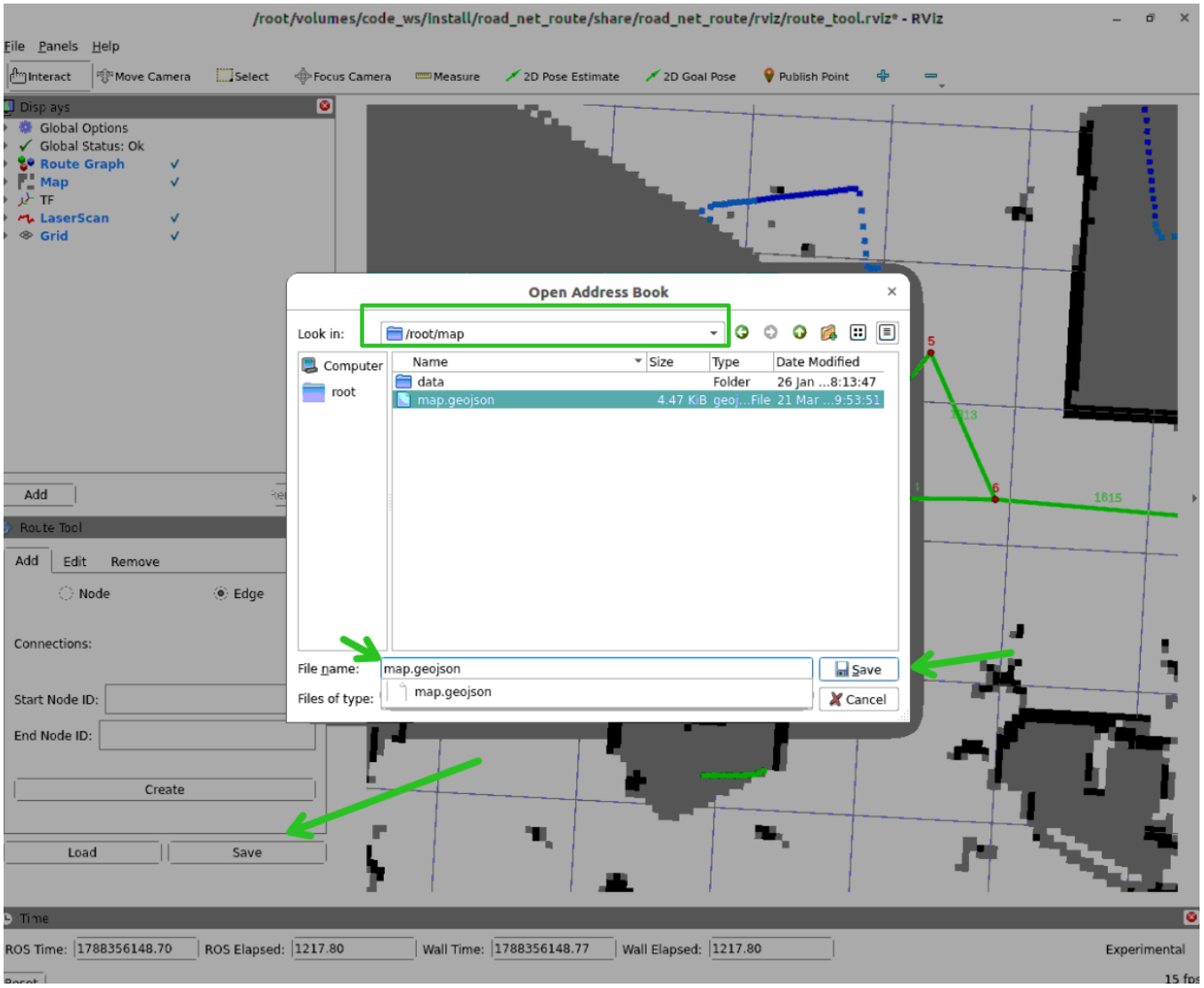


4. Complete the connections for all passable road segments in the site in sequence:

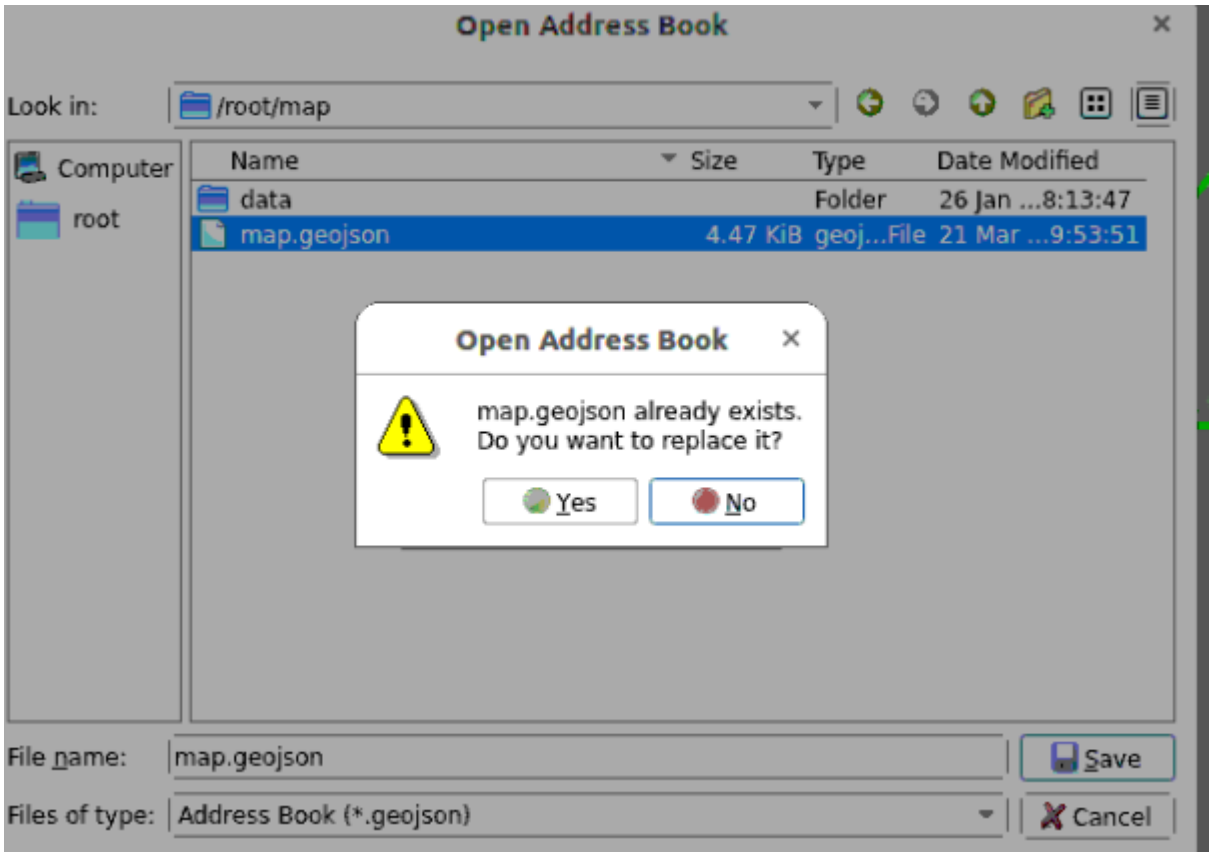


3.4 Save Road Network Description File (`.geojson`)

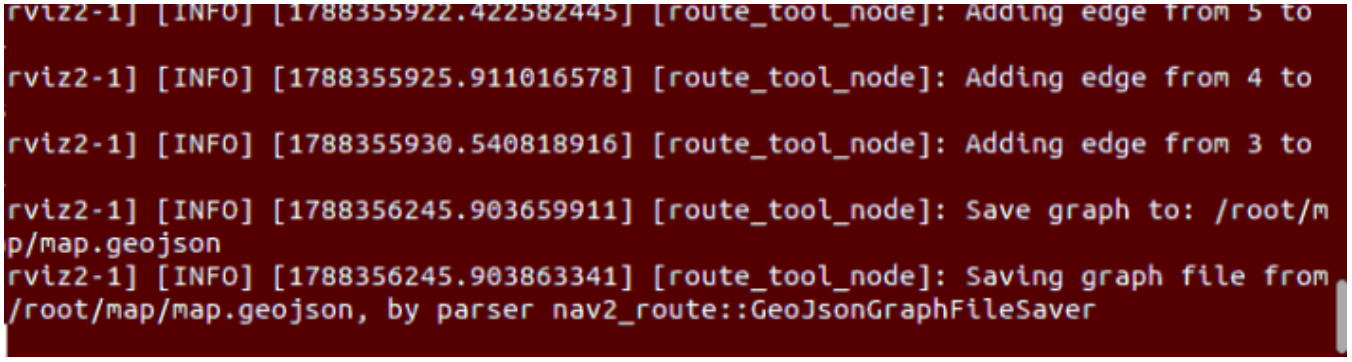
1. Click the `Save` button in the `Route Tool` panel;
2. In the pop-up file save dialog, name the file `map.geojson` (recommended to save in the same `~/map/` directory as the grid map):



Select overwrite.



3. The terminal prints the JSON record indicating successful save:



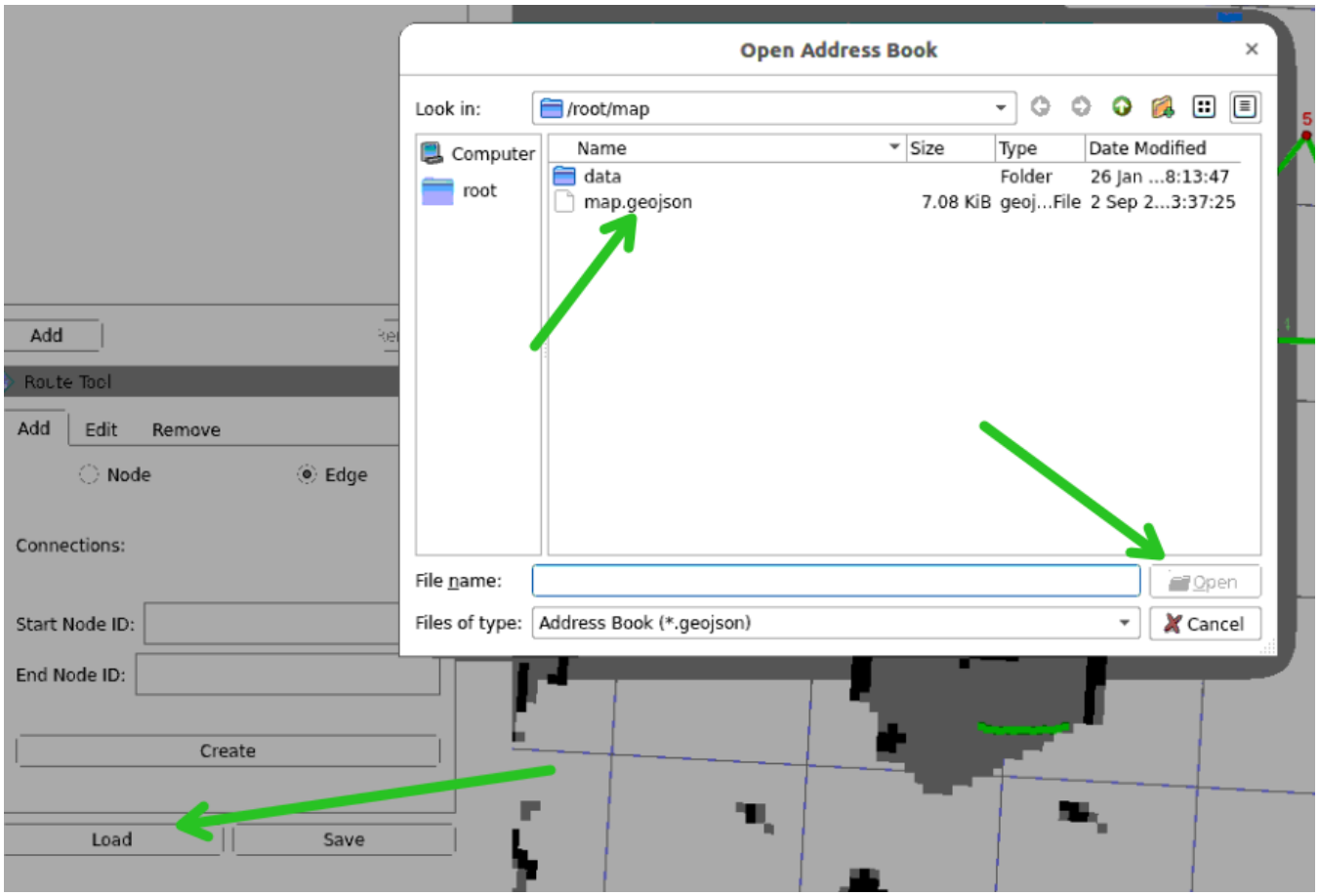
> **Tip**
>
> If the `map.geojson` was annotated and saved on the virtual machine side, use `scp` or a shared folder to copy the file to the robot-side host directory:
>
> ```
> # RDK X5
> cd ~/map
> scp map.geojson sunrise@<robotIP>:/home/sunrise/map/
> ```

4. Loading and Modifying Existing Road Networks

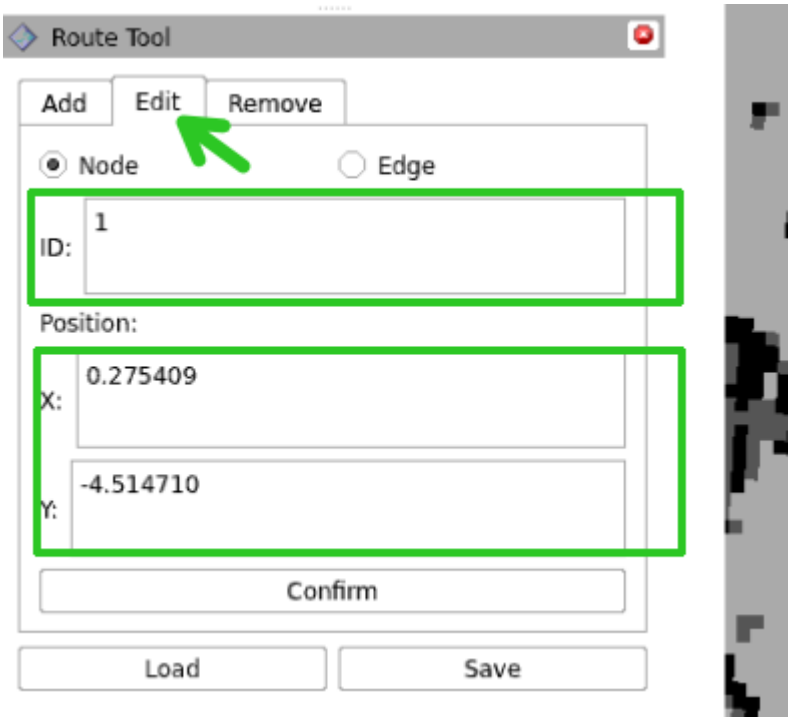
If the site layout changes later and you need to add, delete, or adjust road points and edges, there is no need to rebuild from scratch:

1. Start the `Route Tool` interface;

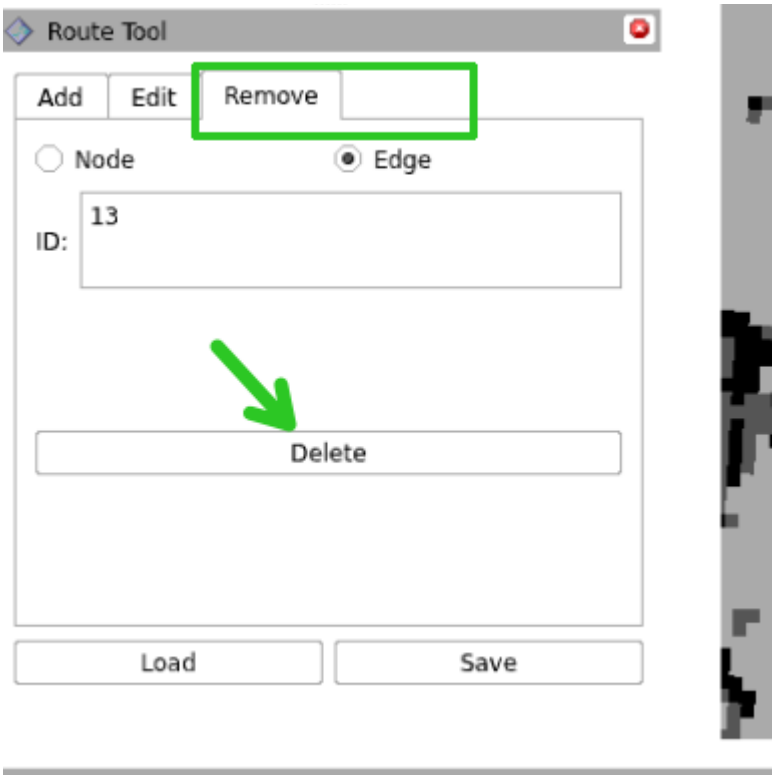
2. Click the `Load` button and select the previously saved `map.geojson` to open:



3. Click `Edit` to re-enter coordinates to modify road point locations, or update edge endpoints;



4. Click `Remove` to directly remove misannotated road points or obsolete road segments. After modifications are complete, click `Save` to overwrite and save.



5. Core Source Code Analysis: GeoJSON Data and RoadNetwork Parser

Source code reference: `code_ws/src/road_net_route/road_net_route/roadnet.py`

5.1 GeoJSON File Standard Format

The `.geojson` generated by the annotation tool follows the standard geographic information structure, containing the two basic elements of the road network: **nodes (Point)** and **road edges (LineString)**:

```
{
  "type": "FeatureCollection",
  "features": [
    {
      "type": "Feature",
      "geometry": { "type": "Point", "coordinates": [1.25, -0.85] },
      "properties": { "id": 1 }
    },
    {
      "type": "Feature",
      "geometry": {
        "type": "LineString",
        "coordinates": [[1.25, -0.85], [2.10, -0.85], [3.10, -0.85]]
      },
      "properties": { "start_id": 1, "end_id": 2, "bidirectional": true }
    }
  ]
}
```

5.2 Python-side Road Network Graph Loading and Topology Construction Logic

When the system starts, the `RoadNetwork` class in `roadnet.py` fully loads this file and converts it into an in-memory data structure that graph algorithms can operate on:

```
# roadnet.py —— Node and edge loading process
def _load(self, roadnet_file: str):
    with open(roadnet_file, 'r') as f:
        data = json.load(f)

    # Phase 1: Extract all Point features to build topology node dictionary
    for feature in data['features']:
        if feature['geometry']['type'] == 'Point':
            node_id = self._parse_node_id(feature['properties'].get("id"))
            if node_id is None:
                continue
            x, y = feature['geometry']['coordinates']
            self.node_coords.append([x, y])
            self.node_ids.append(node_id)
            self.node_coords_by_id[node_id] = (x, y)
            self.adjacency.setdefault(node_id, {})

    # Phase 2: Extract LineString features to build weighted adjacency list and edge
geometry polylines
    for feature in data['features']:
        if feature['geometry']['type'] not in ('LineString', 'MultiLineString'):
            continue
        # Parse edge start and end points (supports multiple compatible aliases like
start_id/end_id, source/target)
        start_id, end_id = self._resolve_edge_endpoints(feature)
        if start_id is None or end_id is None or start_id == end_id:
            continue

        # Calculate geometric Euclidean distance between two points as the topology cost
weight
        weight = self._edge_weight(start_id, end_id)
        self.adjacency.setdefault(start_id, {})[end_id] = weight
        # If it is a bidirectional edge, add reverse adjacency relationship
        self.adjacency.setdefault(end_id, {})[start_id] = weight

        # Save the continuous polyline point set corresponding to this edge for subsequent
path interpolation to generate smooth trajectories
        geometry_points = self._edge_geometry_points(feature['geometry'], start_id, end_id)
        if geometry_points:
            self.edge_geometry_by_nodes[(start_id, end_id)] = geometry_points
            self.edge_geometry_by_nodes[(end_id, start_id)] =
list(reversed(geometry_points))
```

> **Note**

> `RoadNetwork` not only stores the topological connectivity relationships between points (used for fast Dijkstra shortest path finding), but also fully caches the physical curve geometry points of each edge (`edge_geometry_by_nodes`). This enables curved roads to be smoothly sampled into dense navigation paths, rather than generating rigid polylines.